

Day 06 – Linux Fundamentals: Read and Write Text Files

file-io-practice.md

Step 1 — Create a Working Folder

Open your terminal and create a practice folder.

```
❏ mkdir day06-file-io  
cd day06-file-io
```

❏ What this does

- `mkdir` → creates a new directory
- `cd` → moves into that directory

```
Last login: Wed May 20 16:47:29 2026 from 13.48.4.203  
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~$ mkdir day06-file-io  
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~$ cd day06-file-io  
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ touch notes.txt  
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$
```

Step 2 — Create an Empty File

Create the practice file.

```
❏ touch notes.txt
```

❏ What this does

- `touch` creates an empty file named `notes.txt`

Check if the file exists:

```
ls
```

Expected output:

```
notes.txt
```

Step 3 — Write the First Line

Write text into the file using `>`.

```
echo "Line 1 - Linux file practice" > notes.txt
```

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ ls
notes.txt
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ echo "Line 1 - Linux file practice" > notes.txt
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ echo "Line 2 - Learning redirection" >> notes.txt
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$
```

What this does

- `echo` prints text
 - `>` writes text into the file
 - If the file already has content, `>` replaces it
-

Step 4 — Append a Second Line

Add another line using `>>`.

```
echo "Line 2 - Learning redirection" >> notes.txt
```

What this does

- `>>` appends text to the existing file
- It does NOT delete previous content

Step 5 — Append a Third Line Using tee

Use `tee` to display and write at the same time.

```
❏ echo "Line 3 - Using tee command" | tee -a notes.txt
```

```
❏
```

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ echo "Line 3 - Using tee command" | tee -a notes.txt
Line 3 - Using tee command
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$
```

What this does

- `tee` writes output into a file
- `-a` means append
- The line is shown on the terminal and saved to the file

Step 6 — Add More Practice Lines

Add a few more lines to make the file longer.

```
❏ echo "Line 4 - Practicing cat command" >> notes.txt
echo "Line 5 - Practicing head command" >> notes.txt
echo "Line 6 - Practicing tail command" >> notes.txt
echo "Line 7 - DevOps uses text files daily" >> notes.txt
echo "Line 8 - File practice completed" >> notes.txt
```

```
❏
```

Step 7 — Read the Full File

Display the entire file content.

```
❏ cat notes.txt
```

□

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ echo "Line 4 - Practicing cat command" >> notes.txt
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ echo "Line 5 - Practicing head command" >> notes.txt
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ echo "Line 6 - Practicing tail command" >> notes.txt
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ echo "Line 7 - DevOps uses text files daily" >> notes.txt
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ echo "Line 8 - File practice completed" >> notes.txt
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ cat notes.txt
Line 1 - Linux file practice
Line 2 - Learning redirection
Line 3 - Using tee command
Line 4 - Practicing cat command
Line 5 - Practicing head command
Line 6 - Practicing tail command
Line 7 - DevOps uses text files daily
Line 8 - File practice completed
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$
```

Expected Output

```
□Line 1 - Linux file practice
Line 2 - Learning redirection
Line 3 - Using tee command
Line 4 - Practicing cat command
Line 5 - Practicing head command
Line 6 - Practicing tail command
Line 7 - DevOps uses text files daily
Line 8 - File practice completed
```

□

Step 8 — Read the First Few Lines

Use `head` command.

```
□head -n 2 notes.txt
```

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ head -n 2 notes.txt
Line 1 - Linux file practice
Line 2 - Learning redirection
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$
```

□

What this does

- Displays the first 2 lines of the file

Expected output:

□ Line 1 - Linux file practice
Line 2 - Learning redirection
□

Step 9 — Read the Last Few Lines

Use `tail` command.

□ `tail -n 2 notes.txt`

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$ tail -n 2 notes.txt
Line 7 - DevOps uses text files daily
Line 8 - File practice completed
ubuntu@ip-172-31-32-12:~/day06-file-io$
```

What this does

- Displays the last 2 lines of the file

Expected output:

□ Line 7 - DevOps uses text files daily
Line 8 - File practice completed
□
